Tier pack: Independent route — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Produce two distinct thumbnail sketches testing different focal-point positions and background patterns.

Step 2: Build a three-colour complementary or warm/cool swatch strip showing light, mid, and dark values.

Step 3: Develop your chosen layout in the main frame with clear tonal separation between subject and background.

Step 4: Write four concise annotations explaining your focal point, pattern rhythm, colour contrast, and media order.

Success check

Complete studio blueprint with thumbnails, value swatches, and four rationale notes.

Key words helper

• composition: How shapes, lines, and colours are arranged inside the frame.

• focal point: The main area of high contrast that pulls the viewer's eye first.

• thumbnail: A small rapid sketch used to test layout ideas before working big.

• complementary: Colours opposite each other on the colour wheel that create bold contrast.

• balance: Arranging visual weight so the picture feels stable and purposeful.

Review checklist

[ ] Hold your composition plan at arm's length and check that the focal point reads clearly over the pattern.

[ ] Verify that all four choice boxes (focal point, pattern, palette, medium) are annotated.

[ ] Keep your blueprint safe at the front of your log for Week 4.